

Government of India — DGCA Drone Rules 2021

Ministry of Civil Aviation | Published Gazette Notification G.S.R. 589(E)

1. Classification of Unmanned Aircraft Systems

Under Rule 5 of the Drone Rules 2021 (amended 2023), all drones operating in Indian airspace are classified based on Maximum Take-Off Weight (MTOW):

Category	Weight Range (MTOW)	Speed Limit	Registration (UIN)	Remote Pilot Cert.
Nano	<= 250 grams	15 m/s	Exempted	Not Required
Micro	250 grams - 2 kg	25 m/s	Required on DigitalSky	Required for Commercial
Small	2 kg - 25 kg	25 m/s	Required on DigitalSky	Required (RPC)
Medium	25 kg - 150 kg	Limited by TC	Required on DigitalSky	Required (RPC)
Large	> 150 kg	Strict Clearance	Required on DigitalSky	Required (RPC)

2. DigitalSky Airspace Zoning & Permits

Airspace over India is partitioned into Green, Yellow, and Red zones on the DigitalSky platform. No flight permission is required for operating micro and small drones in Green Zones up to 400 feet (120 meters) AGL.

3. NPNT Hardware Compliance & Penalties

No Permission No Take-off (NPNT) is a hardware firmware protocol. Flying in a Red Zone or without valid UIN registration constitutes an offense under Rule 24, subject to penalties up to Rs. 1,00,000 under the Aircraft Act, 1934.